

UNIT

72



QUALITY MANAGEMENT

CONVERSATION

Sarah (Head of Quality Management):

Morning, everyone. I just wanted to share a quick update on what the Quality team's been working on. We've been reviewing our whole QMS and making sure everything aligns with the latest ISO guidelines introduced earlier this year.

Mark (Project Supervisor): Nice. Have we been able to meet all the requirements this time?

Sarah: Almost. There are still a couple of processes being adjusted, mostly related to documentation; our Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) updated last month is fully in place and running smoothly, though.

Emily (Engineer): Yeah, I've noticed the difference. The quality control reports generated recently show fewer issues, and our defect rate recorded this quarter has dropped a lot compared to last quarter.

Sarah: Exactly. We're down about 15%, which is one of the main KPIs tracked this year. That shows we're moving in the right direction.

Mark: That's awesome! You can tell the continuous improvement mindset spreading across teams is really kicking in—people are way more proactive about spotting problems before they happen.

Sarah: That's the goal. Quality isn't just something we check at the end—it's built into every step taken along the process.

Emily: So, what's next for the department?

Sarah: Next, we're expanding our KPIs to include supplier performance, and we'll be running a few short training sessions designed to keep everyone up to speed. Steady improvements—that's what we're after.



VOCABULARY



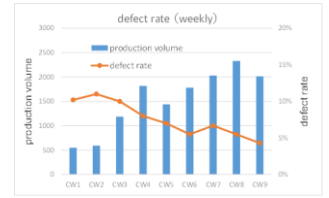
QMS (Quality management system)



Quality control



Continuous improvement



Defect rate



KPI (Key performance indicators)



Meet requirements



ISO



SOP (Standard Operating Procedures)

LANGUAGE PRACTICE

The data **collected** this quarter shows our defect rate went down.

Yeah, the reports **analyzed** last week had already shown that trend.

Right, and the team **working** with the new SOPs helped a lot with that.





EXERCISE 1

Complete the sentences using each word one (QMS, quality control, continuous improvement, defect rate, KPI, meet requirements, ISO, SOP)

- A. Our company follows international _____ standards to guarantee product quality.
- B. We're updating our _____ to make sure all processes are clearly documented.
- C. The new _____ system helps track every stage of production more efficiently.
- D. The _____ team checks every item before it's shipped.
- E. Our main _____ this month is customer satisfaction.
- F. We reduced our _____ by 15% compared to last quarter.
- G. We made several changes to better _____ and deliver consistent results.
- H. Building a culture of _____ is one of our long-term goals.

EXERCISE 2

Rewrite the sentences using participle clauses.

- A. The procedures that were updated last week improved efficiency.
The procedures updated last week improved efficiency.
- B. The team that is working on the new QMS has made great progress.

- C. The reports that were analyzed yesterday showed strong results.

- D. The data that was collected during the audit supports our new KPI.

- E. The employees who are attending the training are adapting fast.

- F. The products that were tested by quality control passed all the standards.

SUMMARY

Relative Clause	Participle Clause	Form
The team that is working on the QMS has made great progress.	The team working on the QMS has made great progress.	Present participle (ing) → Active
The procedures that were updated last week improved efficiency.	The procedures updated last week improved efficiency.	Past participle (ed) → Passive

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. ISO
- B. SOP
- C. QMS
- D. quality control
- E. KPI
- F. defect rate
- G. meet requirements
- H. continuous improvement

Exercise 2

- A. The procedures updated last week improved efficiency.
- B. The team working on the new QMS has made great progress.
- C. The reports analyzed yesterday showed strong results.
- D. The data collected during the audit supports our new KPI.
- E. The employees attending the training are adapting fast.
- F. The products tested by quality control passed all the standards.